

September 22, 2026

Scientific Reports

Dear Dr. Yang,

V4 INTERNAL WORKING DRAFT

This working revision concerns *RankCloak Conceals the Surface Form of Synthetic Cryptographic Artifacts in Language Model Generated Text* (submission 0170c7b2-1065-4344-a5d5-b839b51ac22c).

The V4 revision addresses the editor's technical assessment and Reviewer 1's ten points while retaining Reviewer 2's acknowledgment and all original review wording. It adds complete token-filter documentation, six strict-gate failure analyses with exact text windows and matched comparators, bounded transport decomposition, a configuration compatibility check, source-based complexity analysis and a directional fixed-message quantization endpoint. The conceptual block, integrity, ECC and retransmission fallback is explicitly unimplemented.

The adverse findings remain central. All 960 fixed Q4 messages fail exact recovery when decoded from saved Q8 ranks. The transport decompositions do not establish general robustness. Two blinded control pilots support conditional context gain but fail the prospective semantic-relatedness validation. The subsequent frozen likelihood study is exploratory and cannot prove reader-perceived naturalness. RankCloak concerns surface-form concealment under a shared configuration and does not establish confidentiality or indistinguishability against the evaluated trace-informed attacker.

Internal pending work. Final review of the exploratory study and the unresolved semantic/perceptual support must precede submission. Published version 2.0.0, DOI <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22555497>, covers V3 but not V4. A local release specification is prepared. The final V4 source and evidence must be archived from the exact finalized commit, its inventory verified, and the real version DOI inserted after publication. No new deposit or journal submission has been made in this stage.

Sincerely,

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